

SENATE RESOLUTION 272

By Walley

A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate Rod Barnes on receiving the 2025 National Association of Agricultural Educators' Lifetime Achievement Award.

WHEREAS, the members of this legislative body take great pleasure in recognizing those dedicated educators who help the youth of Tennessee develop into responsible citizens with bright futures in their chosen fields; and

WHEREAS, Rod Barnes is one of only six individuals to be honored by the National Association of Agricultural Educators (NAAE) with the 2025 Lifetime Achievement Award; and

WHEREAS, founded upon the worthy mission of "professionals providing agricultural education for the global community through visionary leadership, advocacy and service," the NAAE bestows the Lifetime Achievement Award upon individuals who have retired from the agricultural education profession and who contributed to the advancement of agricultural education on a regional or national level throughout their careers; and

WHEREAS, after working in production agriculture for many years, Mr. Barnes began his exemplary career in agricultural education at the age of forty-seven, thus bringing real-world experience into the classroom; and

WHEREAS, during his nineteen-year tenure at McNairy Central High School, Mr. Barnes built a thriving agricultural education program through which students earned State and national recognition, developed successful greenhouse and sweet-corn enterprises, and benefited from a new campus livestock learning center that he helped secure; and

WHEREAS, always committed to student success and giving back to his profession, Mr. Barnes taught dual-credit agriculture courses, mentored future agricultural educators, and established a scholarship endowment in honor of his son; and

WHEREAS, while his professional accomplishments are many, Mr. Barnes measures his greatest success through the calls, visits, and messages from former students who credit him with shaping their lives, an enduring testament to his impact as an educator, mentor, and human being; and

WHEREAS, during his tenure at McNairy Central High School, Rod Barnes made a tremendous positive impact through his leadership in developing future leaders in agriculture, and he is worthy of our approbation upon his receipt of this prestigious honor; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that we honor and congratulate Rod Barnes on receiving the 2025 National Association of Agricultural Educators' Lifetime Achievement Award, applaud his commitment to agricultural education and the youth of his community, and extend to him our best wishes for much continued success and happiness.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy.